

Stargate mail relay setup

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Wiki page

Create a stargate relay for a mail domain hosted in Microsoft Office 365

For the relay, we need a VM or a server with a real static IP address.

In this example we will use a VM with IP address `128.140.117.200` and hostname `mail.vrgnservices.eu` to relay mail for domain `vrgnservices.eu`

Set up DNS records:

"A" record, pointing to the IP address: `A mail 128.140.117.200`

"MX" record with higher priority(lower number) than other existing MX record(s):

This record already exists and sets the mail server to Office 365: `MX @ 20 vrgnservices-eu.mail.protection.outlook.com.`

This is the new record to be added: `MX @ 15 mail.vrgnservices.eu.`

Edit the SPF record to add the IP address of the stargate relay server, change

from `TXT @ "v=spf1 include:spf.protection.outlook.com -all"`

to `TXT @ "v=spf1 ip4:128.140.117.200 include:spf.protection.outlook.com -all"`

Verify the records:

```
# host mail.vrgnservices.eu
mail.vrgnservices.eu has address 128.140.117.200
# host -t mx vrgnservices.eu
vrgnservices.eu mail is handled by 20 vrgnservices-eu.mail.protection.outlook.com.
vrgnservices.eu mail is handled by 15 mail.vrgnservices.eu.
# host -t txt vrgnservices.eu|grep v=spf1
vrgnservices.eu descriptive text "v=spf1 ip4:128.140.117.200 include:spf.protection.outlook.com -all"
#
```

Install the stargate docker compose containers:

<https://code.veraign.com/svdh/stargate-deployment>

Requirements:

- **Root access:** Must be run as root or with `sudo`
- **Supported distributions:**
 - Ubuntu 22 and newer
 - Debian 12 and newer
 - RHEL-based (CentOS, Rocky Linux, AlmaLinux) version 9 and newer
- **Real IPv4 address**
- **Valid DNS records:** Your domain must have:
 - MX records pointing to your mail servers
 - SPF record defining allowed sending networks

If the hostname of the VM/server is set to mail.example.com the script will set up the mail domain to be the same as "hostname -d" by default, but a different domain can be chosen with the `MAIL_DOMAIN` environment variable. It installs all components, extracts the necessary mail relay settings from DNS, applies them in the configuration and starts them.

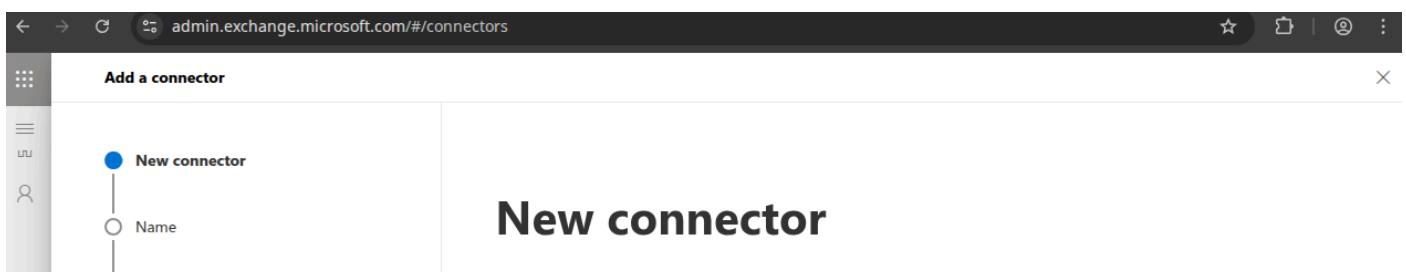
Set up Exchange:

We need to configure connectors and a transport rule in Exchange to relay all outgoing mail to the postfix relay and allow incoming mail from it.

Navigate to <https://admin.exchange.microsoft.com/#/connectors>

Create outgoing mail connector, click "Add":

Select "Connection from": "Office 365" "Connection to": "your organization's email server, click "Next".



Specify your mail flow scenario, and we'll let you know if you need to set up a connector.

Connection from

☒ Office 365

☐ Your organization's email server

☐ Partner organization

Connection to

☒ Your organization's email server

☐ Partner organization

Next

Name it something like "From Office 365 to postfix relay sever" and check "Retain Internal Exchange email headers", click "Next".

Add a connector

✓ New connector

● Name

○ Use of connector

○ Routing

○ Security restrictions

○ Validation email

○ Review connector

Connector name

This connector lets Office 365 deliver messages to your organization's email server.

Name *

From Office 365 to postfix relay server

Description

What do you want to do after connector is saved? ⓘ

☒ Turn it on

☒ Retain internal Exchange email headers

Back Next

Select "Only when I have a transport rule set up that redirects messages to this connector", click Next,.

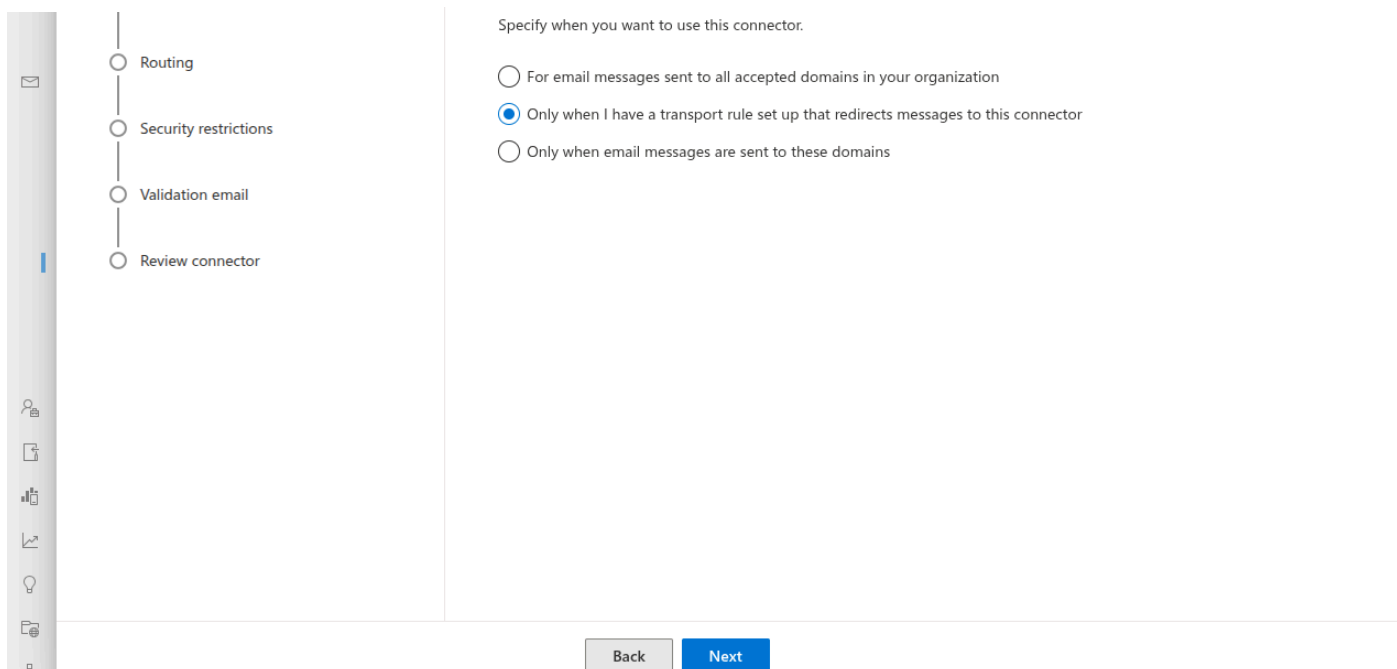
Add a connector

✓ New connector

✓ Name

● Use of connector

Use of connector



Specify when you want to use this connector.

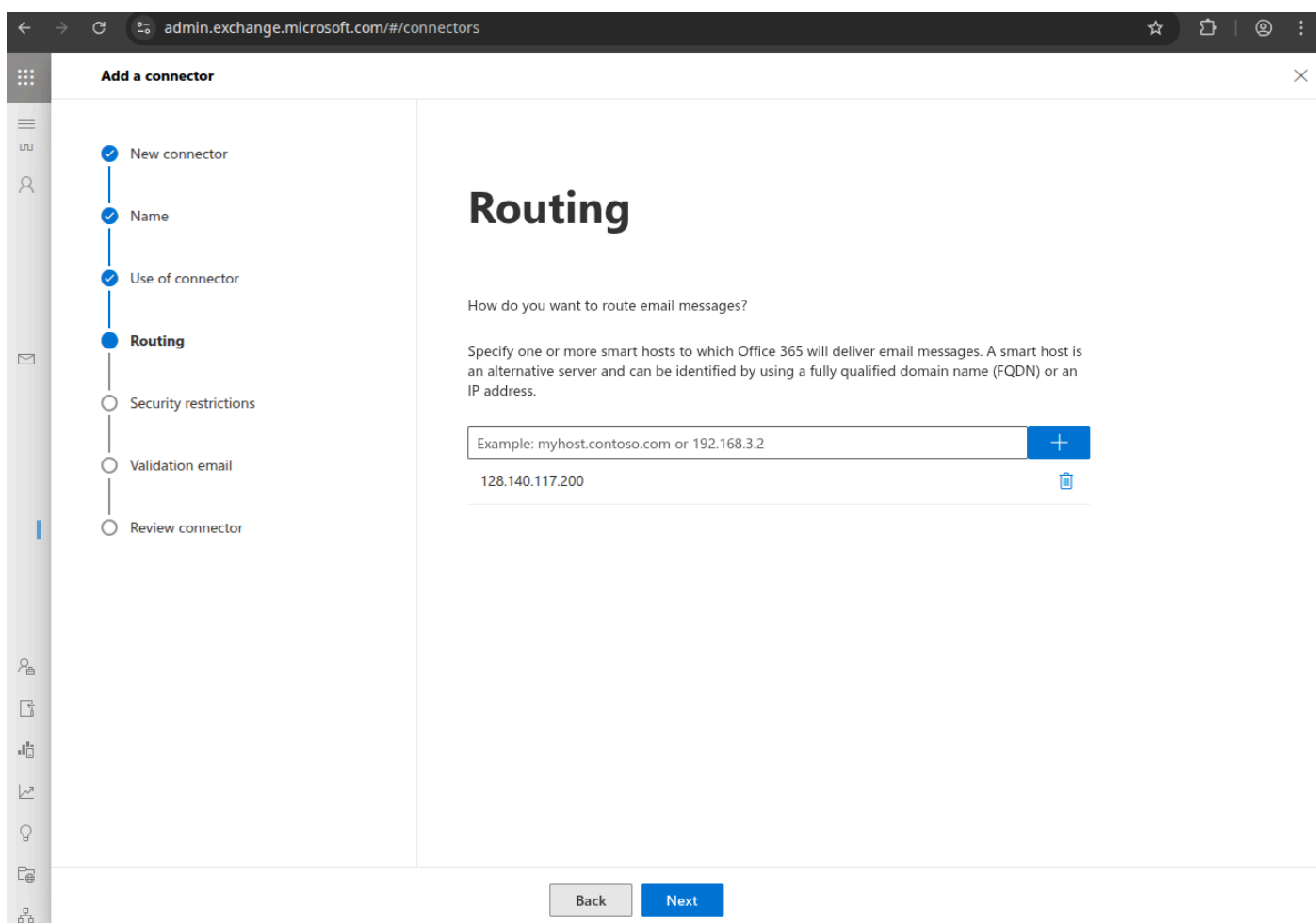
☐ For email messages sent to all accepted domains in your organization

☒ Only when I have a transport rule set up that redirects messages to this connector

☐ Only when email messages are sent to these domains

Back Next

Enter the IP address of the postfix relay server, click "+", click "Next".



admin.exchange.microsoft.com/#/connectors

Add a connector

New connector

Name

Use of connector

Routing

Security restrictions

Validation email

Review connector

Routing

How do you want to route email messages?

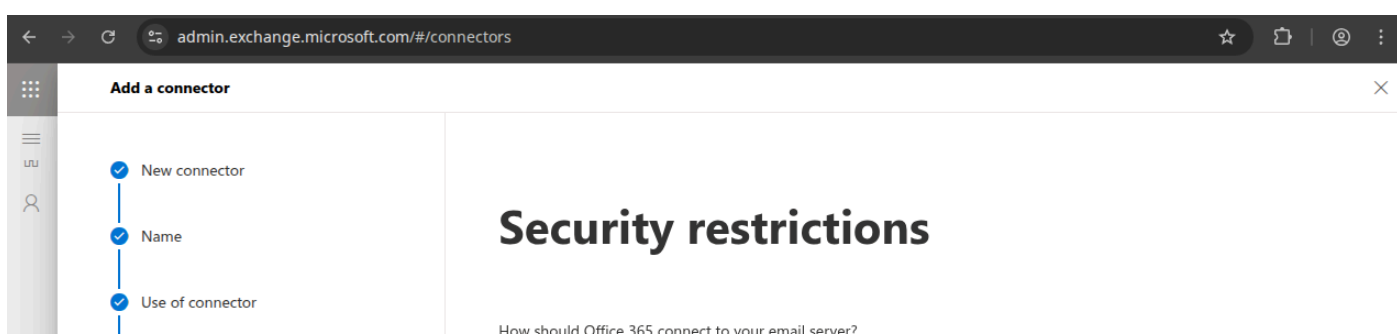
Specify one or more smart hosts to which Office 365 will deliver email messages. A smart host is an alternative server and can be identified by using a fully qualified domain name (FQDN) or an IP address.

Example: myhost.contoso.com or 192.168.3.2

128.140.117.200

Back Next

Select "Any digital certificate, including self-signed certificates", click "Next".



admin.exchange.microsoft.com/#/connectors

Add a connector

New connector

Name

Use of connector

Security restrictions

How should Office 365 connect to your email server?

The screenshot shows the 'Security restrictions' step in the Exchange Admin Center connector setup wizard. On the left, a vertical navigation pane shows the progress: Routing (checked), Security restrictions (active), Validation email (unchecked), and Review connector (unchecked). The main content area has the heading 'Security restrictions' and a checkbox 'Always use Transport Layer Security (TLS) to secure the connection (recommended)' which is checked. Below it, a note says 'Connect only if the recipient's email server certificate matches this criteria'. There are two radio button options: 'Any digital certificate, including self-signed certificates' (selected) and 'Issued by a trusted certificate authority (CA)'. Below these is an unchecked checkbox 'Add the subject name or subject alternative name (SAN) matches this domain name:' with a text box containing the example 'contoso.com or *.contoso.com'. At the bottom are 'Back' and 'Next' buttons.

Enter a valid email address for your domain, click "+", click "Validate", click "Next".

The screenshot shows the 'Validation email' step in the Exchange Admin Center connector setup wizard. The left navigation pane shows the progress: New connector (checked), Name (checked), Use of connector (checked), Routing (checked), Security restrictions (checked), Validation email (active), and Review connector (unchecked). The main content area has the heading 'Validation email' and a subheading 'Specify an email address for an active mailbox that's on your email server. You can add multiple addresses if your organization has more than one domain.' Below this is a text input field with 'Example: user@contoso.com' and a blue '+' button. Below that is another text input field with 'komitoveu@vrgnservices.eu' and a trash icon. A 'Validate' button is below the second field. A green success message 'Validation successful' is displayed. Below this is a table with the following data:

>	Task	Status
>	Check connectivity to '128.140.117.200'	Succeed
>	Send test email	Succeed

At the bottom are 'Back' and 'Next' buttons.

Click "Create connector".

The screenshot shows the 'Review connector' step in the Exchange Admin Center connector setup wizard. The left navigation pane shows the progress: New connector (checked), Name (checked), Authenticating sent email (checked), and Review connector (active). The main content area has the heading 'Review connector' and a subheading 'Mail flow scenario'. Below this is a text input field for the mail flow scenario. At the bottom are 'Back' and 'Next' buttons.



REVIEW CONNECTOR

From: Your organization's email server
To: Office 365

Name
Receive mail from postfix relay server

Status
Turn it on after saving
Retain internal Exchange email headers (recommended)
[Edit name](#)

How to identify email sent from your email server
Identify incoming messages from your email server by verifying that the sending server's IP address is within these IP address ranges: 128.140.117.200, and the sender's or recipient's email address is an accepted domain for your organization.
[Edit sent email identity](#)

Back

Create connector

Click "Add another connector".

admin.exchange.microsoft.com/#/connectors

Add a connector

✓ New connector

✓ Name

✓ Use of connector

✓ Routing

✓ Security restrictions

✓ Validation email

✓ Review connector

✓ Connector created

[Add another connector](#)

Done

Create incoming mail connector, choose "Connection from": "Your organization's email server", click "Next".

admin.exchange.microsoft.com/#/connectors

Add a connector

New connector

Name

Authenticating sent email

Review connector

New connector

Specify your mail flow scenario, and we'll let you know if you need to set up a connector.

Connection from

Add a connector

Connector name

This connector lets Office 365 deliver messages from your organization's email server.

Name *

Receive mail from postfix relay server

Description

What do you want to do after connector is saved? ⓘ

☒ Turn it on

☒ Retain internal Exchange email headers

Next

Name it something like "Receive mail from postfix relay server" and check "Retain internal Exchange email headers", click "Next".

Add a connector

Authenticating sent email

How should Office 365 identify email from your email server?

Choose how Office 365 will authenticate and accept email sent from your email server.

Back **Next**

Select "By verifying that the IP address of the sending server matches one of the following IP addresses, type the IP address of postfix, click "+", click "Next".

Add a connector

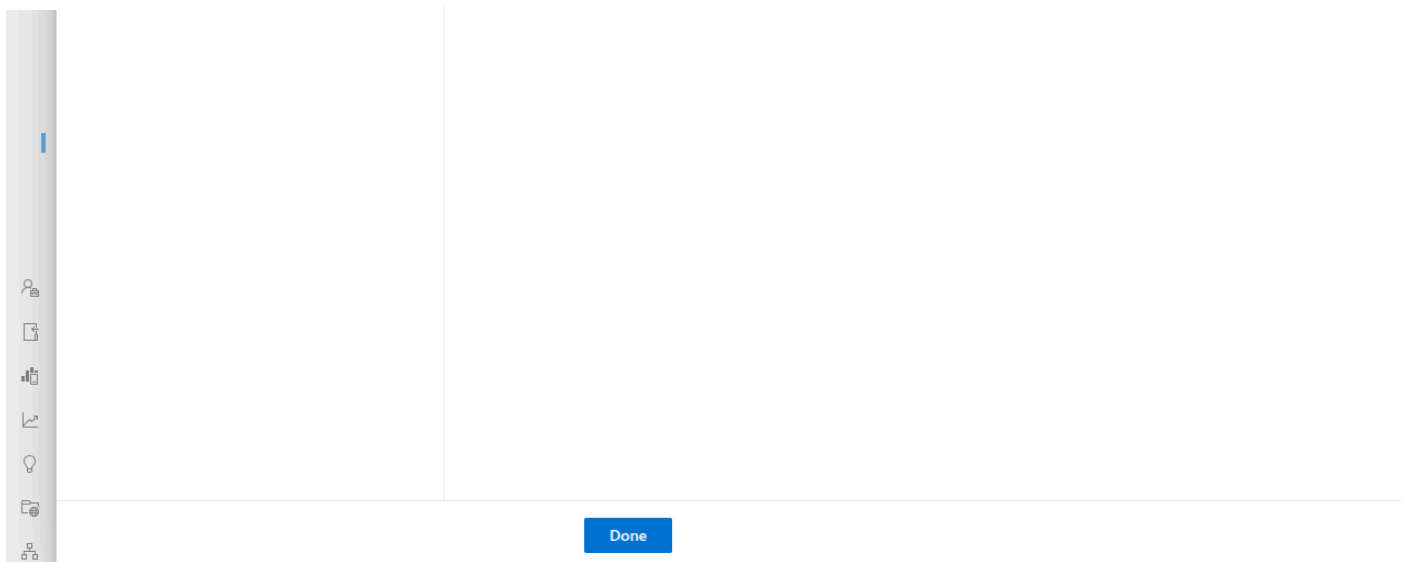
Review connector

Back **Next**

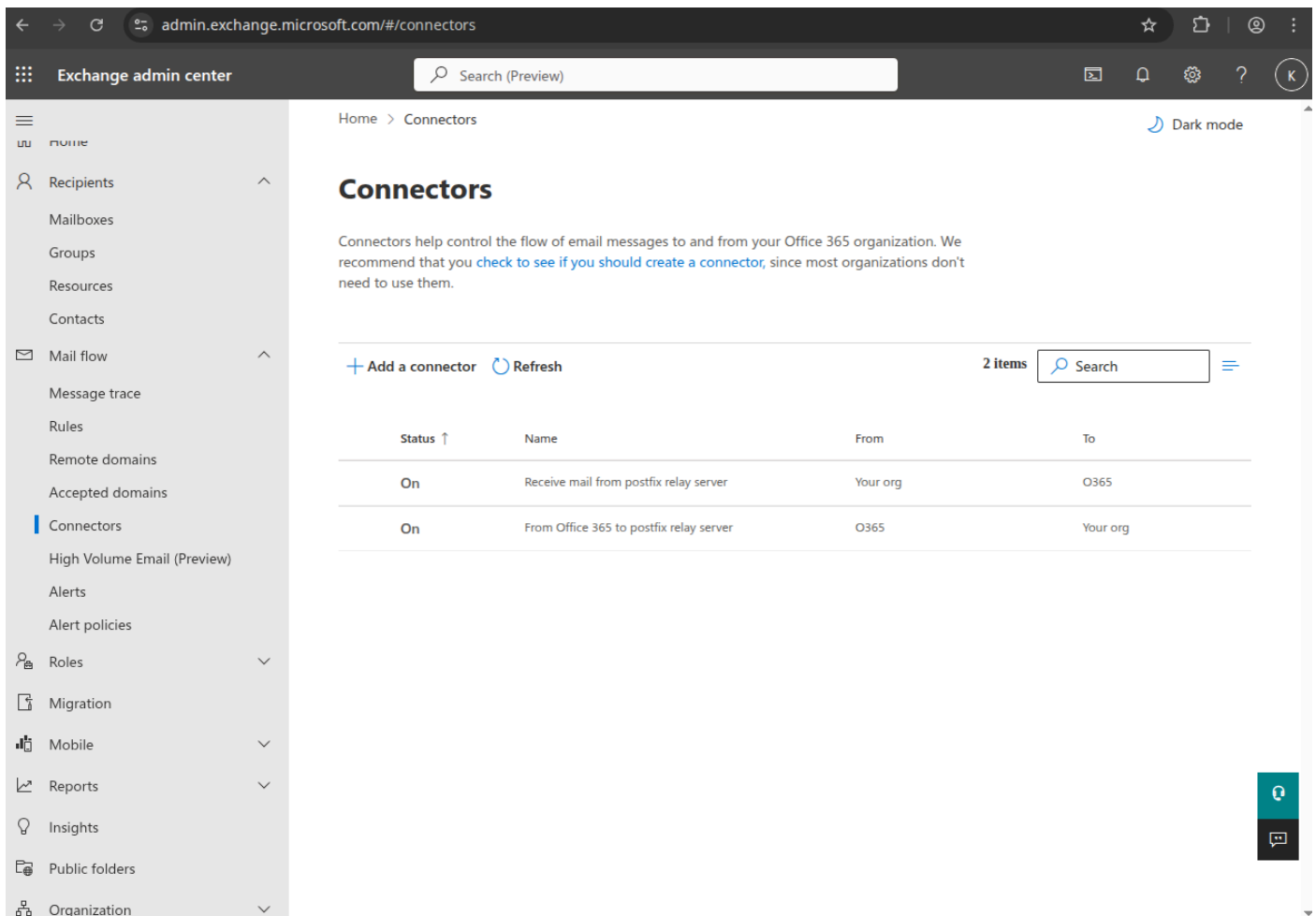
Click "Create connector".

Click "Done".

7/14

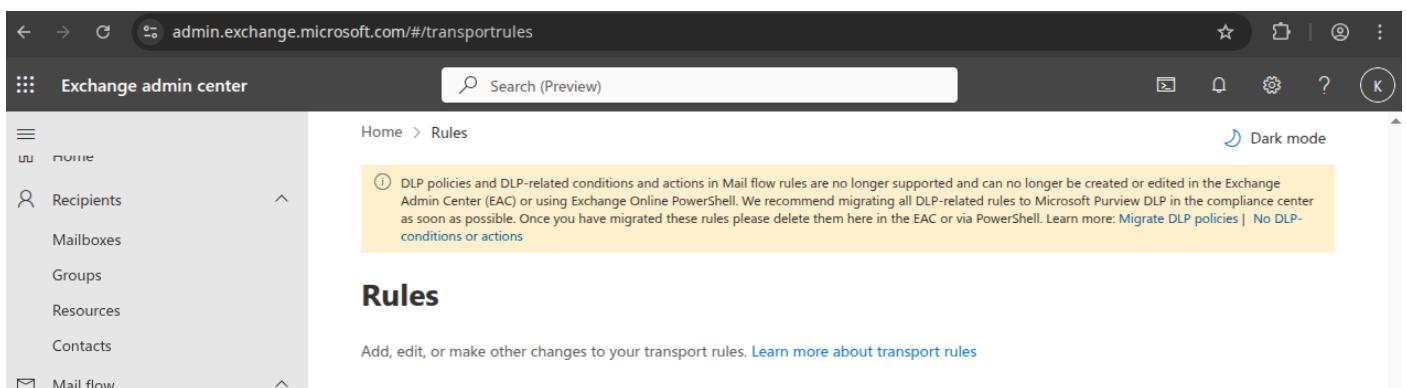


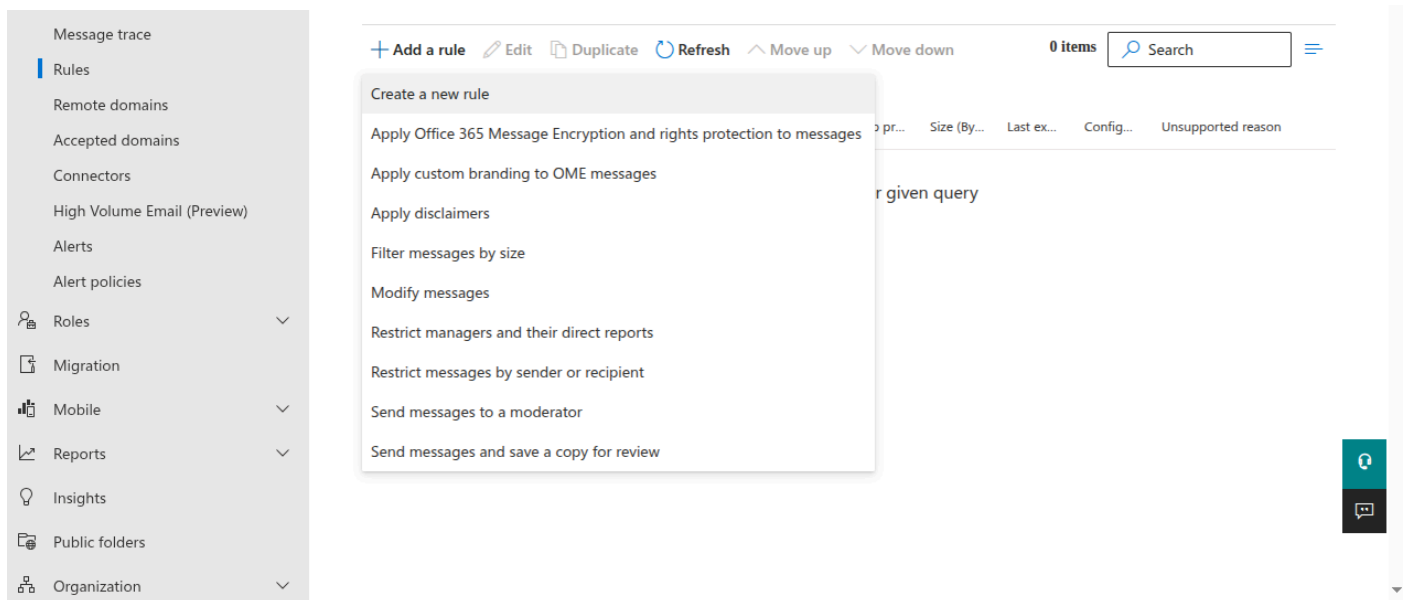
This is how it looks when done:



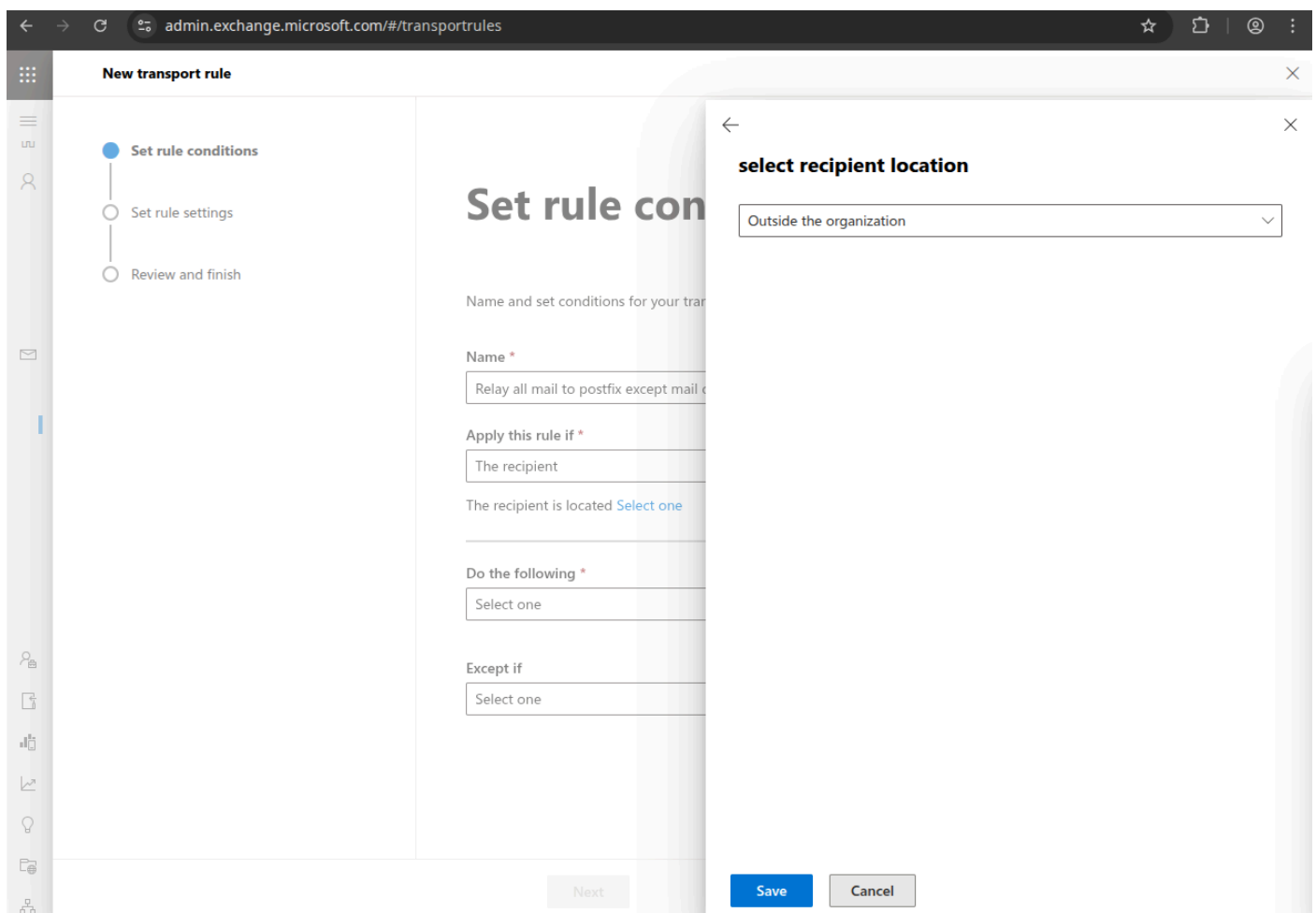
Create the transport rule, navigate to <https://admin.exchange.microsoft.com/#/transportrules>

Click "+Add a rule" ->"Create a new rule".

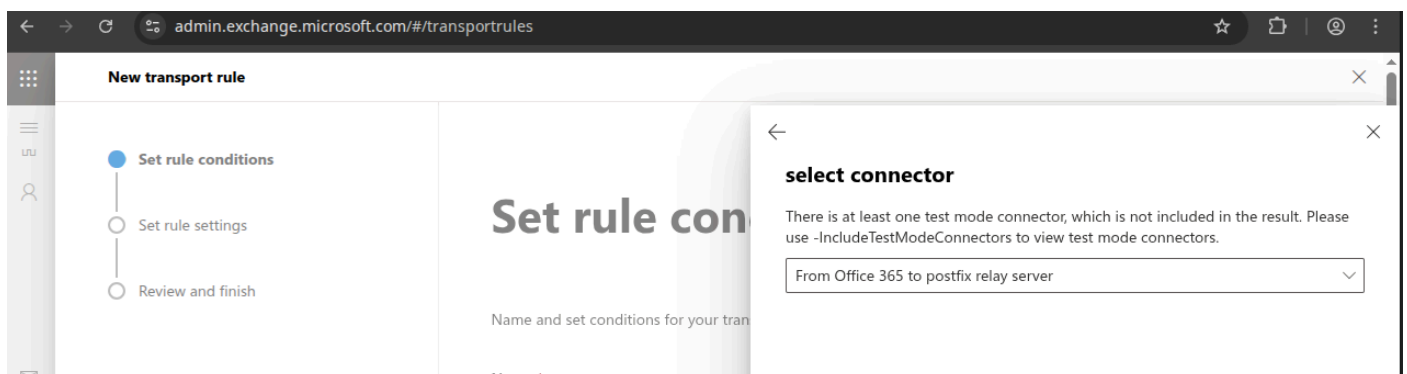




Name it something like "Relay all mail to postfix except mail coming from it", choose "Apply rule if" "The recipient:" "is external/internal" "Outside the organization", click "Save".



Choose "Do the following" "Redirect message to the following connector" "From Office 365 to postfix relay server", click "Save".



Relay all mail to postfix except mail c

Apply this rule if *

The recipient

The recipient is located 'NotInOrganiz

Do the following *

Redirect the message to

route the message using the following

Except if

Select one

Next

Choose "Except if The sender IP address is in any of these ranges" enter the IP address of the postfix server, click "Add", check the IP address and click "Save".

This is needed to prevent mail loops, as this rule also applies to other domains hosted in Office 365.

admin.exchange.microsoft.com/#/transportrules

New transport rule

Set rule conditions

Set rule settings

Review and finish

Set rule conditions

Name and set conditions for your transport rule

Name *

Relay all mail to postfix except mail c

Apply this rule if *

The recipient

The recipient is located 'NotInOrganiz

Do the following *

Redirect the message to

route the message using the following

Except if

The sender

Sender's IP address is in the range Enter an IPv4 or IPv6 address, or range

specify IP address ranges

Enter an IPv4 or IPv6 address, or range

Add

Edit Delete

1 item

128.140.117.200

Next

Save

Cancel

Now it should look like this, click "Next":

admin.exchange.microsoft.com/#/transportrules

New transport rule

Set rule conditions

Set rule settings

Review and finish

Set rule conditions

Name and set conditions for your transport rule

Name *

Relay all mail to postfix except mail c

Apply this rule if *

The recipient

The recipient is located 'NotInOrganiz

Do the following *

Redirect the message to

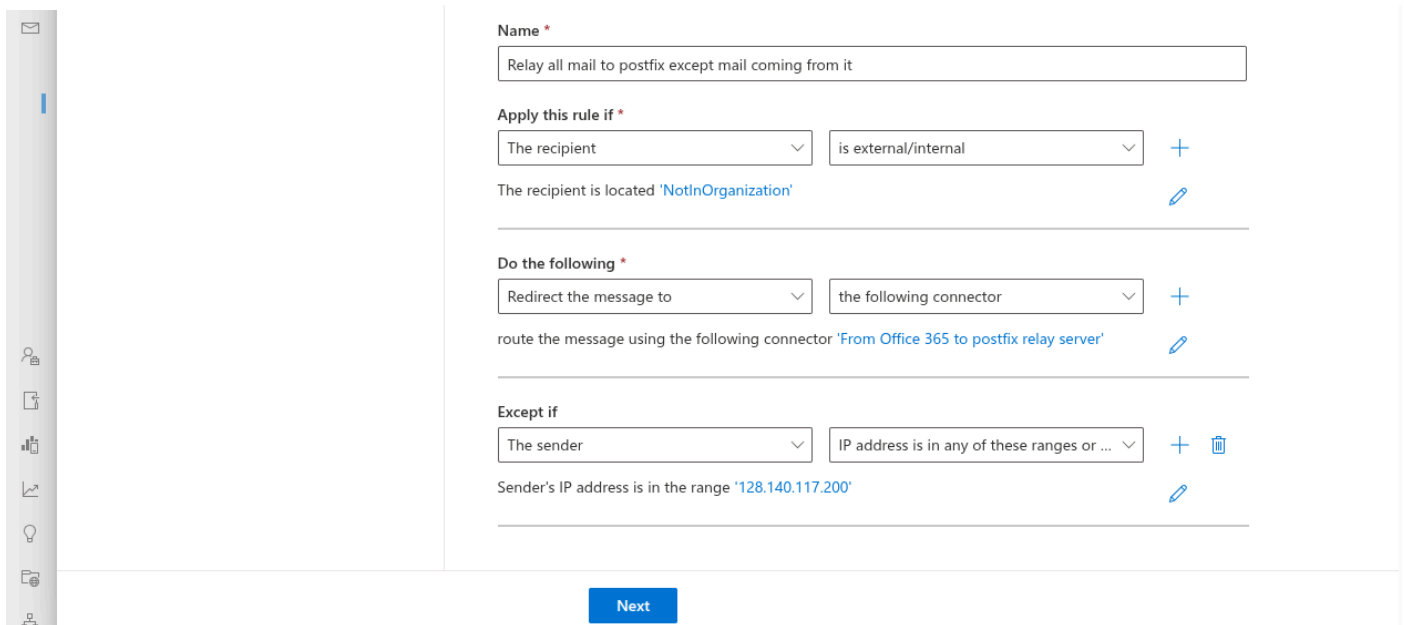
route the message using the following

Except if

The sender

Sender's IP address is in the range Enter an IPv4 or IPv6 address, or range

Next



Name *

Relay all mail to postfix except mail coming from it

Apply this rule if *

The recipient is external/internal

The recipient is located 'NotInOrganization'

Do the following *

Redirect the message to the following connector

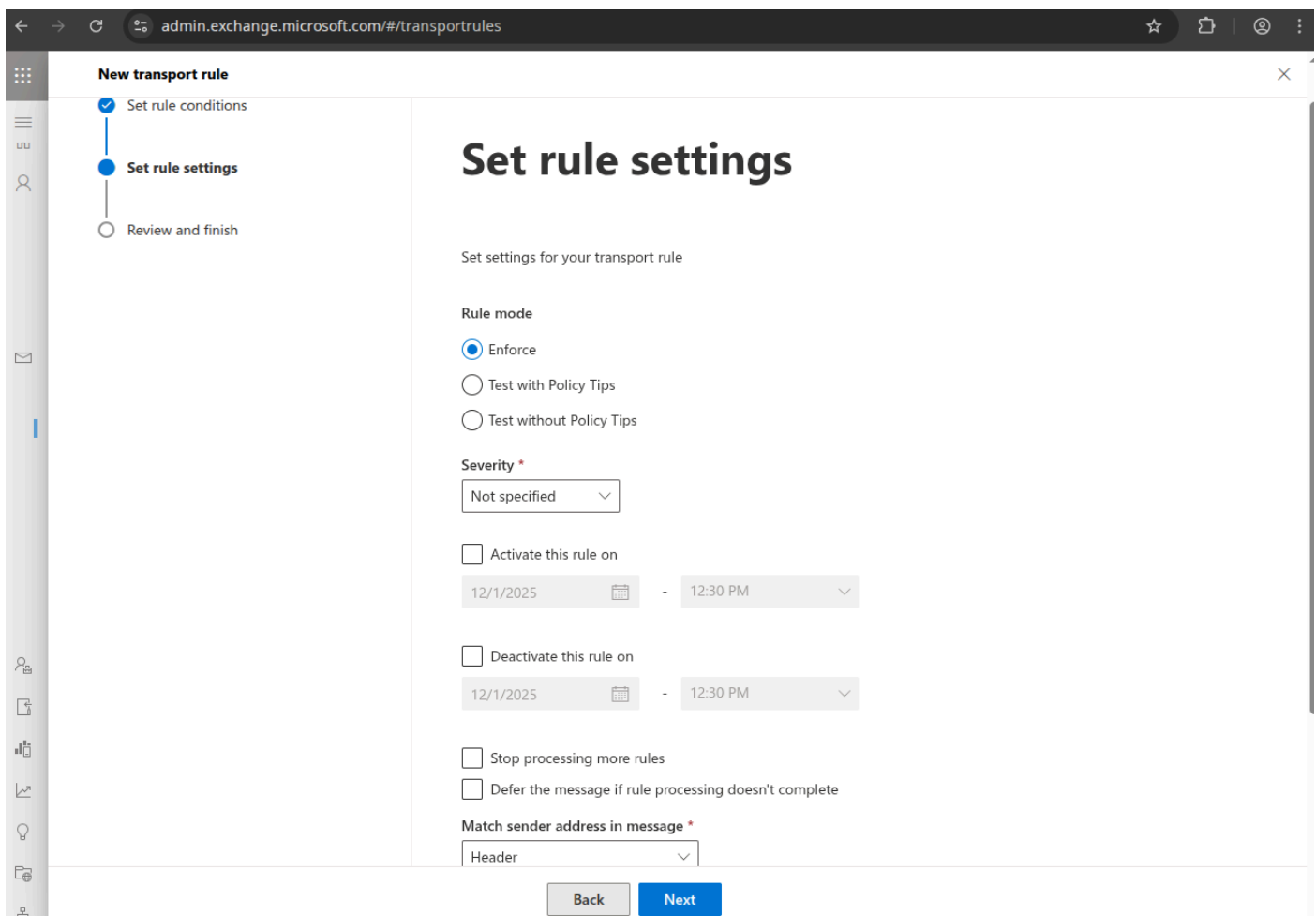
route the message using the following connector 'From Office 365 to postfix relay server'

Except if

The sender's IP address is in the range '128.140.117.200'

Next

Click "Next".



New transport rule

Set rule conditions

Set rule settings

Review and finish

Set rule settings

Set settings for your transport rule

Rule mode

☒ Enforce

☐ Test with Policy Tips

☐ Test without Policy Tips

Severity *

Not specified

☐ Activate this rule on

12/1/2025 - 12:30 PM

☐ Deactivate this rule on

12/1/2025 - 12:30 PM

☐ Stop processing more rules

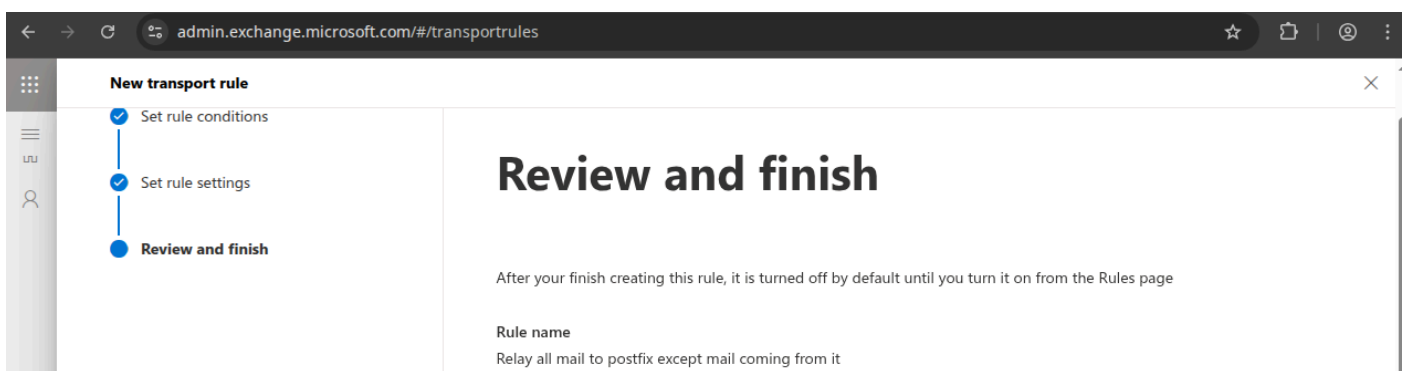
☐ Defer the message if rule processing doesn't complete

Match sender address in message *

Header

Back **Next**

Click "Finish".



New transport rule

Set rule conditions

Set rule settings

Review and finish

Review and finish

After your finish creating this rule, it is turned off by default until you turn it on from the Rules page

Rule name

Relay all mail to postfix except mail coming from it

Click "Done".

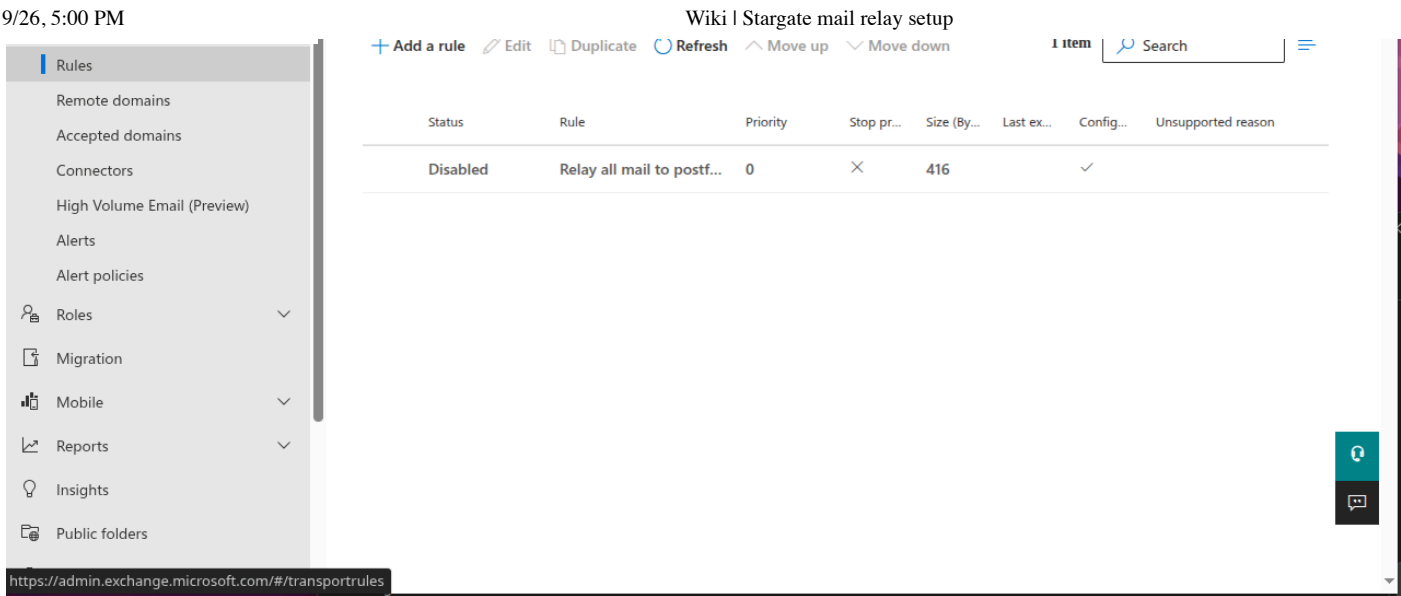
Done

[Home](#) > [Rules](#)

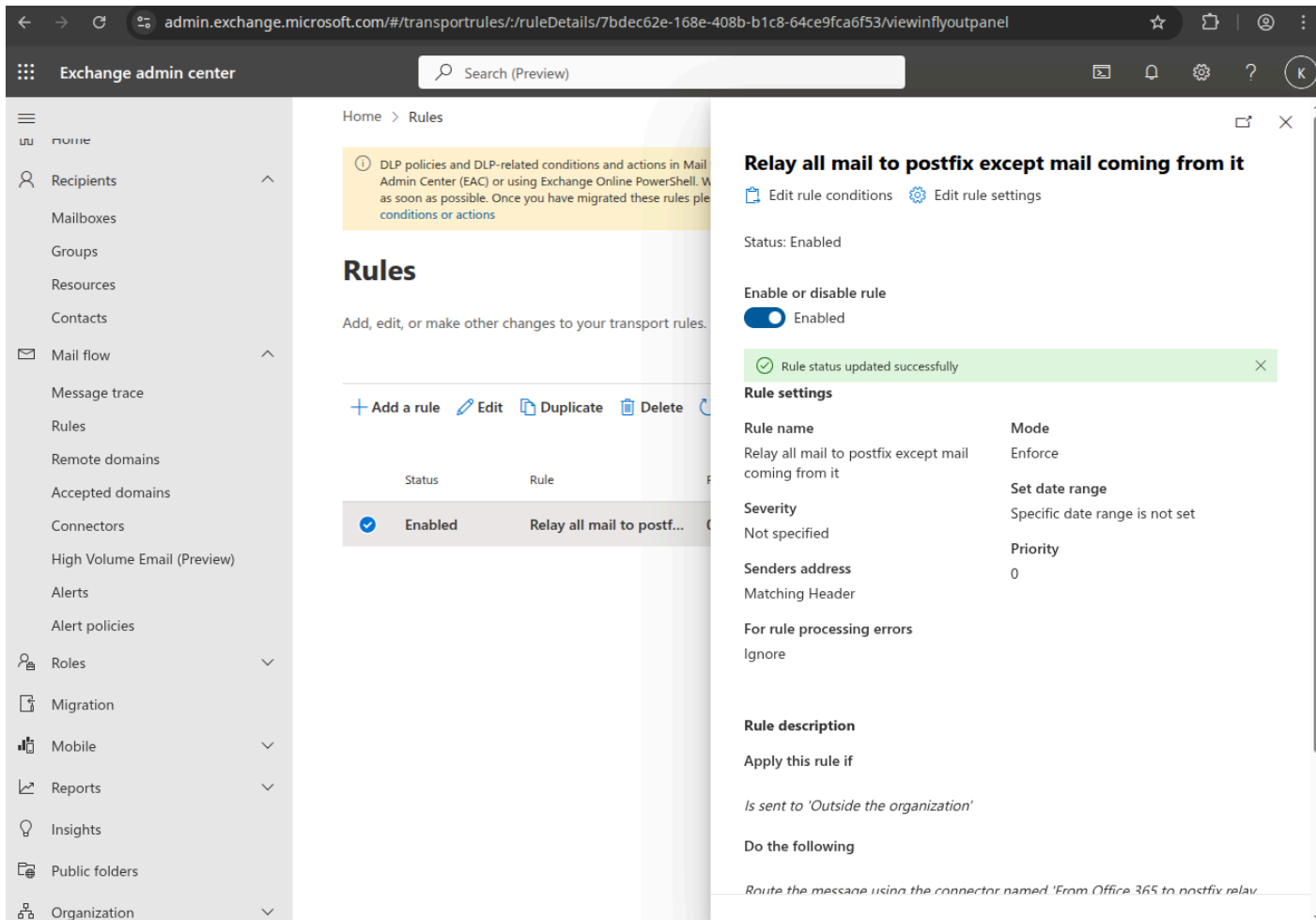
① DLP policies and DLP-related conditions and actions in Mail flow rules are no longer supported and can no longer be created or edited in the Exchange Admin Center (EAC) or using Exchange Online PowerShell. We recommend migrating all DLP-related rules to Microsoft Purview DLP in the compliance center as soon as possible. Once you have migrated these rules please delete them here in the EAC or via PowerShell. Learn more: [Migrate DLP policies](#) | [No DLP-conditions or actions](#)

Rules

Add, edit, or make other changes to your transport rules. [Learn more about transport rules](#)



Click on the rule and set the "Enable or disable rule to "Enabled"



 new_transport_rule10.png

ZK

 new_transport_rule9.png

ZK

 new_transport_rule8.png

ZK

 new_transport_rule7.png

ZK

 new_transport_rule6.png

ZK

 new_transport_rule5.png

ZK

 new_transport_rule4.png

ZK

 new_transport_rule3.png

ZK